



FREE CHECKLIST

Print-Ready Artwork Checklist

Tick every line before you send files to press. Nine out of ten delays happen in prepress, and this list prevents all of them.

- ☐ **1. Bleed**
Background colour and images extend 3 mm beyond the trim line on every side.
- ☐ **2. Safe zone**
Text, logos and barcodes sit at least 3–5 mm inside the trim line (10 mm on packaging folds).
- ☐ **3. Resolution**
Images are 300 dpi at final size (150 dpi is acceptable for large-format print).
- ☐ **4. Colour mode**
Everything is CMYK. Spot colours are named Pantone swatches. No RGB, no Lab.
- ☐ **5. Rich black**
Large black areas use C60 M40 Y40 K100. Small text and thin lines use K100 only.
- ☐ **6. Fonts**
All text converted to outlines, or fonts packaged with the file. Body text ≥ 6 pt, legal text ≥ 4 pt.
- ☐ **7. Dieline**
Artwork is placed on the printer's dieline on its own non-printing spot-colour layer, set to overprint.
- ☐ **8. Overprint**
Overprint preview checked. No white objects set to overprint. Knockouts where needed.
- ☐ **9. Barcodes**
EAN/UPC $\geq 80\%$ magnification, quiet zones intact, dark bars on light background, verified.
- ☐ **10. Transparency**
Transparency and effects flattened or exported as PDF/X-4. No missing links.
- ☐ **11. Page setup**
Single pages in reading order, correct trim size, no marks inside the artwork area, spreads exported as single pages.



12. Export

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PDF/X-4 or PDF/X-1a, crop marks on, 3 mm bleed, fonts embedded, no security or passwords.

Packaging extras

- Glue flaps are free of ink and varnish unless the printer confirms a glueable coating.
- Artwork on adjacent panels reads correctly when folded; make a paper mock-up.
- Window positions match the die; mandatory information fits the panel space.

Need it printed? Send this to PrintPack Lanka for a costed proposal within one working day, with a free dieline and sample for packaging.

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